Disciple Making Movements – From DMM to CPM

David Watson, a former church planter in Northern India with International Mission Board (IMB), recognized the emerging Disciple Making Movements (DMM's) leading to Church Planting Movements (CPM's). Watson reported that 40,000 churches had been started in the previous fifteen years in North India. Based on that experience he described the process of starting CPMs as follows:

1) church planter finds access to friendship with disconnected people;
2) church planter serves and loves disconnected friends;
3) church planter identifies a person of peace out of those friends;
4) church planter works with person of peace to invite his/her social unit (family or affinity group) into a 15–30-week inductive Bible study led by person of peace or someone else from social unit;
5) the group decides to follow Jesus and becomes a church;
6) new churches send out church planters to start the process again.

Watson's strategy of DMM catalysts emphasized not so much knowledge but obedience, not so much doctrine but doing. Foundational for a DMM catalyst was to find a man/woman/son of peace as the Lord commanded, and mentor those he was training to reproduce what he was sharing with them as the Lord said to his disciples "And if a son of peace is there, your peace will rest upon him. But if not, it will return to you" (Luke 10:6).

From the very beginning, each person in the group is encouraged to make disciples by starting groups of their own to reproduce what they are discovering in Scripture.[6] They teach practical topics such as the art of intercessory prayer, engaging lost people, finding a "person of peace," and facilitating "Discovery Bible Studies" that leads to a DMM which in turn becomes a CPM-a church planting movement.